

The continued deposition of raw sewage has transfigured the Nairobi River – my community's sole source of water – into a black stream of poison, curtailing access to potable water and snatching the lives of many compelled to ingest its water. Although the reverse osmosis system I designed could only provide clean drinking water to a mere fraction of this population, it was the first meaningful contribution I made to remedying this menacing issue.

By majoring in Environmental Sciences at Weinberg, I hope to gain the skill set to knowledgeably engage my community in the proper management of wastewater. The Health of the Biosphere and Humans and the Environment courses will be crucial in understanding the specific human-environment interactions that have adverse implications on water sources, and how to halt and deter the strain of affected water systems, allowing their rehabilitation. The research on the metal-organic framework by Northwestern researchers is especially intriguing as it presents a sustainable procedure for the degradation of polyester-based plastic, another major water contaminant, preventing its accumulation in water ways. Its efficiency and cost-effectiveness make it ideal for Kenya.

At the Center for Water Research, I hope to learn about and utilize Professor Sera Young's scales in accessing the prevalence of water insecurity, enabling the prevention of economic water scarcity which threatens many underprivileged communities in my country.

Delving into the fundamentals of jazz at Bienen, spreading far the fame with NUMB, exchanging folklore with the close-knit community at Bobb, and occasionally immersing myself in animated chats with Wildcats from the Association of Kenyan Students are just a few of the aspects I hope to highlight my Northwestern experience – one in which Northwestern is truly home!